INTRODUCTORY SOMMELIER COURSE AND EXAM

AND

CERTIFIED SOMMELIER THEORY EXAM

CURRICULUM GUIDE

INTRODUCTORY & CERTIFIED THEORY CURRICULUM

Subject Name: ITALY - NORTHERN ITALY - PIEDMONT

Learning Outcome Introductory Sommelier Course: After studying this section, a student will know the grape varieties, appellations, and styles of important Piedmont wines.

Learning Outcome Certified Sommelier Exam: After studying this section, a candidate will know the major DOCGs within Piedmont, know their grape varieties, understand their styles, aging requirements, and labeling laws. A Certified Sommelier will be able to recognize iconic producers and be able to sell and recommend food pairings with Barolo and Barbaresco to a guest.

	Introductory Level	Certified Sommelier Exam
Geography: Location	On the border of Switzerland and France.	
Geography: Climate Categories	Continental	
Geography: Physical Feature	**Mountains:** Apennine Mountains, Alps, which provide a rain shadow. Piedmont refers to the foothills of the Alps. **Bodies of Water:** Po River (Po River Valley)	Tanaro River Langhe Hills
Wine: White Grape Variety Names	Moscato, Arneis, Cortese	
Wine: Red Grape Variety Names	Nebbiolo, Barbera, Dolcetto, Brachetto	**Spanna:** Local name for Nebbiolo in Gattinara and Ghemme.
Soil: Type and/or Name		**Barolo:** Differences in soil types.
Grape Growing		
Winemaking	Traditional aging in large barrels. Aging requirements (law) exist for Barolo and Barbaresco.	**Actual Requirements:** **Barolo:** 38 months total aging with a min of 18 months in oak. **Barbaresco:** 26 months total aging with a min of 9 months in oak.
Classification	IGP, DOC, DOCG	
Wine Law / Appellations: DOCGs/DOCs	**Barolo DOCG:** Dry red wine from the Nebbiolo grape variety.	**Barolo DOCG:** Identify on a map. Know Tanaro River and Langhe Hills.
	Barbaresco DOCG: Dry red wines from the Nebbiolo grape variety.	**Top Barolo Vineyards:** Cannubi, Brunate, and Monprivato
	Moscato d'Asti DOCG: Off-dry, semi-sparkling white wine from the Moscato grape variety**.**	**Barbaresco DOCG:** Identify on a map. Know Tanaro River and Langhe Hills.
	Gavi DOCG: Dry white wines, made from the Cortese grape variety.	**Top Barbaresco Vineyards:** Ovello, Montestefano, Pora, Asili
	Barbera d'Asti DOCG: Dry red wines made from the Barbera grape variety**.**	**Asti DOCG:** Fully sparkling Moscato.
		Brachetto d'Acqui DOCG: Off-dry, semi-sparkling red wine from Brachetto.
		Alta Langa DOCG: Metodo Classico sparkling wines, min combined 90% Pinot Noir and/or Chardonnay.
		Roero DOCG: Dry red wines from Nebbiolo grape variety.
		Roero Arneis DOCG: Dry white wines from Arneis.
		Ghemme DOCG: Dry red wines from Nebbiolo, locally known as *Spanna.*
		Gattinara DOCG: Dry red wines from Nebbiolo, locally known as *Spanna.*

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Subject Name: ITALY - NORTHERN ITALY - PIEDMONT

	Introductory Level	Certified Sommelier Exam
Label Terms		Normale Riserva
General Terms	**Nebbia:** Local name of fog rolling off the foothills of the Alps.	**Sorì:** best site (privileged site)
Style	**All:** Dry, sweet, sparkling, red, white	
Producers/Proprietary Brand		**Barolo:** Vietti, Giacomo Conterno, Bruno Giacosa, Ceretto, Sandrone, Elio Altare, Giuseppe Mascarello **Barbaresco:** Gaja, La Spinetta, Produttori del Barbaresco, Vietti, Bruno Giacosa, Ceretto
Vintage		Know the best vintages for Barolo and Barbaresco over the last 10 years.
History & Lore		Traditional vs. Modernist Barolo and Barbaresco styles.
Service of Beverage		Long range of ageability for Barolo and Barbaresco.
Food and Beverage Pairing		Big tannins require meat or fat.
Business of the Sommelier		

INTRODUCTORY & CERTIFIED THEORY CURRICULUM

Subject Name: ITALY - NORTHERN ITALY - LOMBARDY & EMILIA-ROMAGNA

Learning Outcome Introductory Sommelier Course: After studying this section, a student will understand the style of Franciacorta, its grape varieties, aging requirements, and how it compares to Champagne.

Learning Outcome Certified Sommelier Exam: After studying this section, a student will be able to understand different styles of Franciacorta, know the grape variety and style of Valtellina Superiore DOCG, and know the styles and sub-zones of Lambrusco. A Certified Sommelier recognize iconic producers and be able to sell and recommend food pairings with Franciacorta to a guest.

	Introductory Level	Certified Sommelier Exam
Geography: Location	**Lombardy:** Northern Italy on the border of Switzerland. **Emilia-Romagna:** Straddles North and Central Italy.	
Geography: Climate Categories	Cool Continental	
Geography: Physical Feature	**Lombardy:** **Mountains:** Foothills of the Alps **Bodies of Water:** Many lakes influence the region **Emilia-Romagna:** **Mountains:** Apennine Mountains	
Soil: Type and/or Name		
Grape Growing		
Winemaking:	Metodo Classico Sparkling Wines	**Lombardy:** Passito wines made from dried grapes. **Emilia-Romagna:** Frizzante or spumante sparkling wines **Lambrusco:** Commonly cuve close but can be Metodo Classico or Methode Ancestrale and can be frizzante or spumante.
Wine: White Grape Variety Names	Chardonnay, Pinot Bianco (Pinot Blanc)	
Wine: Red Grape Variety Names	Pinot Nero (Pinot Noir)	**Lambrusco:** Lambrusco **Chiavennasca:** Local name for Nebbiolo in Valtellina
Classification	IGP, DOC, DOCG	

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Subject Name: NORTHERN ITALY - LOMBARDY & EMILIA-ROMAGNA

	Introductory Level	Certified Sommelier Exam
Wine Law/Appellations: DOC and DOCGs	**Franciacorta DOCG:** Pinot Nero, Chardonnay, Pinot Bianco Spumante, metodo classico sparkling wine. Min 18 months aging on the lees, 25 months total aging from the date of harvest.	**Lombardy:** **Valtellina Superiore DOCG:** Dry red wines from Nebbiolo locally known as Chiavennasca. **Sforzato di Valtellina DOCG:** Passito-dried Chiavennasca. **Franciacorta Satèn DOCG:** Brut only, max pressure of 5 atmospheres, Chardonnay with a max of up to 50% Pinot Bianco. **Emilia-Romagna:** **Lambrusco DOC:** **Style:** Frizzante or spumante **Subzones:** Lambrusco di Sorbara DOC, Lambrusco Grasparossa di Castelvetro DOC, Lambrusco Salamino di Santa Croce DOC **Sweetness levels:** Secco, Amabile, Dolce
Label Terms	**Franciacorta:** Metodo Classico, Spumante, Millesimato, Frizzante	Secco, Amabile, Dolce
General Terms		
Style		
Producers/Proprietary Brand		**Franciacorta:** Bellavista, Ca' del Bosco
Vintage		
History & Lore		
Service of Beverage		CMS-A published Sparkling Wine Service Standards. Lambrusco is served as you would any other sparkling wine, cold and in a flute or wine glass.
Food and Beverage Pairing		**Lambrusco:** In Emilia-Romagna, the breadbasket of Italy, near Modena and Reggio known for Parmesan, salami, Balsamic Vinegar. **Franciacorta:** Very flexible with food pairings like Champagne.
Business of the Sommelier		Limited shelf life of effervescence for Lambrusco if pouring by the glass.

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Subject Name: ITALY - NORTHERN ITALY - TRENTINO-ALTO ADIGE / FRIULI / VENETO

Learning Outcome Introductory Sommelier Course: After studying this section, a student will know the major DOC/DOCGs in Northeast Italy, be able to match grape varieties with their regions, and understand general labeling terms.

Learning Outcome Certified Sommelier Exam: After studying this section, a candidate will know a broader range of DOC/DOCGs in Northeast Italy, match grape varieties to their regions, and understand winemaking styles. A Certified Sommelier will be able to recognize iconic producers and be able to sell and recommend food pairings with wines from these regions to a guest.

	Introductory Level	Certified Sommelier Exam
Geography: Location	**Trentino-Alto Adige:** Northeastern Italy- border of Austria and Switzerland. **Friuli:** Northeastern Italy - border of Slovenia. **Veneto:** Northeastern Italy, includes Venice and Verona.	
Geography: Climate Categories	**Trentino-Alto Adige/Friuli:** Cool Continental **Veneto:** Cool Mediterranean, closer to the east	
Geography: Physical Feature	**Trentino-Alto Adige/Friuli:** Alps	
Soil: Type and/or Name		
Grape Growing		
Winemaking	**Trentino-Alto Adige/Friuli:** Single grape variety wines, noted on the wine label.	**Friuli:** Orange wine and natural wines
Wine: White Grape Variety Names	**Trentino-Alto Adige:** Pinot Grigio, Chardonnay, Sauvignon Blanc, Pinot Bianco **Veneto:** Garganega, Glera **Friuli:** Pinot Bianco, Chardonnay, Pinot Grigio, and Sauvignon Blanc (called Sauvignon)	**Friuli:** Friulano, Ribolla Gialla **Veneto:** Trebbiano di Soave, Chardonnay
Wine: Red Grape Variety Names	**Trentino-Alto Adige:** Pinot Nero **Friuli:** Merlot **Veneto:** Corvina, Rondinella	**Trentino-Alto Adige:** Teroldego, Lagrein **Friuli:** Refosco dal Peduncolo Rosso
Classification	IGP, DOC, DOCG	
Wine Law / Appellations: DOCGs/DOCs	**Delle Venezie DOC/Trevenezie IGP:** Includes the entire regions of Veneto, Friuli, and the Trentino portion of Trentino-Alto Adige. **Trentino-Alto Adige:** Most of production is DOC status- single grape variety wines.	**Trentino-Alto Adige:** Alto-Adige (Südtiroler) DOC, Trentino DOC, Valdadige DOC **Friuli:** Friuli Isonzo DOC, Friuli Colli Orientali DOC, Friuli Grave DOC

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Subject Name: NORTHERN ITALY - TRENTINO-ALTO ADIGE / FRIULI / VENETO

	Introductory Level	Certified Sommelier Exam
	Veneto	**Veneto**
Wine Law / Appellations: DOCGs/DOCs	**Prosecco DOC:** Spumante wines made in the Charmat method from the Glera grape variety. **Soave DOC/Soave Superiore DOCG:** Dry white wines made mostly from the Garganega grape variety. Superiore has elevated alcohol and longer minimum aging requirements. **Valpolicella DOC:** Dry red wines primarily from the Corvina and Rondinella grape varieties. **Amarone della Valpolicella DOCG:** Red wine primarily from Corvina with Rondinella. Uses the Appassimento process of drying the grapes and concentrating sugars. Minimum 14% abv and residual sugar is often perceptible.	**Conegliano Valdobbiadene Prosecco Spumante Superiore DOCG:** More specific designation for Prosecco, higher alcohol requirement**.** **Recioto di Soave DOCG:** Sweet white wine made from Garganega grapes dried in the Appassimento method. **Recioto di Valpolicella DOCG:** Sweet red wine made from Corvina and Rondinella grapes dried in the Appassimento method. **Valpolicella Ripasso DOC:** Corvina and Rondinella grapes. Use of the remaining must and lees from the production of Recioto della Valpolicella and/or Amarone della Valpolicella. Young wine is combined with the lees and goes through a short second fermentation. This leads to wines with more flavor, tannin, and alcohol.
Label Terms		
General Terms	Classico, Superiore, Secco, Amabile, Charmat, Appassimento	Recioto
Style		
Classification		
Producers/Proprietary Brand		**Trentino-Alto Adige:** Cantina Terlano, Tiefenbrunner
		Friuli: Jermann, Movia, Livio Felluga, Schioppettino, Josko Gravner
		Veneto, Amarone: Bertani, Masi, Allegrini, Tommasi, Dal Forno, Quintarelli
		Veneto, Prosecco: Bisol, Mionetto, La Marca, Zonin, Zardetto
Vintage		
History & Lore		Many of the producers in Alto-Adige are co-ops. Be familiar with the history of Amarone.
Service of Beverage		
Food and Beverage Pairing		
Business of the Sommelier		

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Subject Name: ITALY - TUSCANY

Learning Outcome Introductory Sommelier Course: After studying this section, a student will know the grape varieties, appellations, and styles of important Tuscan wines.

Learning Outcome Certified Sommelier Exam: After studying this section, a candidate will understand the differences between multiple regions of Sangiovese, and know and understand DOC/DOCG wines from regions in Tuscany. A Certified Sommelier recognize iconic producers and be able to sell and recommend food pairings with wines from Tuscany to a guest.

	Introductory Level	Certified Sommelier Exam
Geography: Location	Extends from the Ligurian Sea in the west to the foothills of the Apennine Mountains in the east.	Identify Chianti, Chianti Classico, Montalcino, and Bolgheri on a map.
Geography: Climate Categories	Continental/Maritime, stronger Maritime influence with proximity to the coast.	
Geography: Physical Feature	Apennine Mountains	Ligurian Sea, Tyrrhenian Sea
Wine: White Grape Variety Names		Trebbiano, Vermentino, Vernaccia
Wine: Red Grape Variety Names	Sangiovese, Brunello/Sangiovese Grosso	Prugnolo Gentile, Cabernet Sauvignon, Merlot, Cabernet Franc
Soil: Type and/or Name	Galestro	**Montalcino:** Clay and marine sediments at lower elevation, Galestro at higher elevation.
Grape Growing		
Winemaking	**Brunello di Montalcino:** wine law requires these wines be aged and stipulates minimum amount of aging**.**	**Brunello di Montalcino:** Know the minimum aging requirements; use of large Slavonian or small barriques.
Style	Dry red wines Dry white wines Sweet Vin Santo	Sangiovese-based wines have a moderate intensity of color and tart acidity that outweighs tannin. Volatile Acidity is common in these wines.
Classification	IGP, DOC, DOCG	Gran Selezione (know that it exists, not specific rules)
Wine Law / Appellations: DOCGs/DOCs	Chianti DOCG Chianti Classico DOCG Brunello di Montalcino DOCG Rosso di Montalcino DOCG Vin Santo	Brunello di Montalcino: 100% Brunello Chianti Classico: min 80% Sangiovese Chianti: min 70% Sangiovese Vino Nobile di Montepulciano DOCG Bolgheri DOC Rosso di Montepulciano DOC Vin Santo DOCs (multiple)

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Subject Name: ITALY - TUSCANY

	Introductory Level	Certified Sommelier Exam
Label Terms	**Superiore:** Increased alcohol level required **Classico:** Classic center of a region **Riserva:** Longer aging times required	Gran Selezione (know that it exists, not specific rules)
General Terms	**Super Tuscan:** Can be Bordeaux grape variety blends, Bordeaux varieties with Sangiovese, and pure Sangiovese wines.	Rosso, Bianco, Dolce, Passito
Producers/Proprietary Brand	Antinori, Ruffino, Sassicaia	Ornellaia, Masseto, Tignanello, Solaia, Biondi Santi, Banfi, Soldera, La Pergole Torte. Recognize important producers of Brunello di Montalcino.
Vintage		Know the top Brunello di Montalcino vintages in the past 15 years.
History & Lore	Super Tuscan history Gallo Nero on Chianti Classico bottles	
Service of Beverage		Decant young Brunello di Montalcino.
Food and Beverage Pairing		Know pairings for Chianti and Brunello. Have producers in mind if you recommend them.
Business of the Sommelier		Know current release of Brunello di Montalcino and approximate price of top proprietary brands.

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Subject Name: ITALY - CENTRAL & SOUTHERN ITALY

Learning Outcome Introductory Sommelier Course: After studying this section, a student will understand and recognize the regions of Central and Southern Italy and be able to match grape varieties to major DOC/DOCGs.

Learning Outcome Certified Sommelier Exam: After studying this section, a candidate will know the DOC/DOCGs in Central and Southern Italy, match grape varieties to their regions, and understand winemaking styles.

	Introductory Level	Certified Sommelier Exam
Geography: Location	Extends from the Ligurian Sea in the west to the foothills of the Apennine Mountains in the east.	
Geography: Appellation	**Central:** **Umbria:** Sagrantino di Montefalco DOCG **Marche** **Abruzzo:** Montepulciano d'Abruzzo DOC **Southern:** **Campania**: Taurasi DOCG, Greco di Tufo DOCG, Fiano di Avellino DOCG **Puglia** **Basilicata** **Calabria**	**Identify all major regions of Central and Southern Italy on a map.** **Marche:** Verdicchio di Matelica DOC, Verdicchio dei Castelli di Jesi DOC
Geography: Climate Categories	**Central:** Maritime on the coast and Continental inland. **South:** Mediterranean	
Geography: Physical Feature	**Central:** Apennine Mountains	Ligurian Sea, Tyrrhenian Sea, Adriatic Sea, Mt. Vesuvius
Soil: Type and/or Name		**Campania:** Volcanic
Grape Growing		
Winemaking		
Wine: White Grape Variety Names	Fiano, Greco, Verdicchio	
Wine: Red Grape Variety Names	Aglianico, Montepulciano, Sagrantino, Primitivo	
Classification	IGP, DOC, DOCG	
Wine Law / Appellations: DOCGs/DOCs		**Match DOCG to Major Region:** **Campania:** Taurasi DOCG, Greco di Tufo DOCG, Fiano di Avellino DOCG **Marche:** Verdicchio dei Castelli di Jesi DOC, Verdicchio di Matelica DOC

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	Introductory Level	Certified Sommelier Exam
Label Terms	**Superiore**: Higher alcohol level requirement **Riserva:** Longer aging requirements	
General Terms		
Style		
Producer/Proprietary Brand		Know producers, cuvées, and vintages if you recommend them in the Hospitality and Service Exam.
Vintage		
History & Lore		
Service of Beverage		Young Taurasi and Sagrantino di Montefalco should be decanted.
Food and Beverage Pairing		
Business of the Sommelier		

INTRODUCTORY & CERTIFIED THEORY CURRICULUM

Subject Name: ITALY - ISLANDS - SICILY & SARDINIA

Learning Outcome Introductory Sommelier Course: After studying this section, a student will be able to locate Sicily and Sardinia on a map, understand the climate of the regions, and know the major grape varieties grown.

Learning Outcome Certified Sommelier Exam: After studying this section, a candidate will be able to match grape varieties to major DOC/DOCGs and know the larger region within Italy in which they are located.

	Introductory Level	Certified Sommelier Exam
Geography: Location	**Sardinia:** Island located south of France and west of Italy. **Sicily**: Islands off the southern tip of Italy. ***Locate and identify on a map.**	Identify major regions on a map.
Geography: Climate Categories	Mediterranean	
Geography: Physical Feature	Mt. Etna	Tyrrhenian Sea, Mt. Etna
Soil: Type and/or Name	Volcanic in Etna	
Grape Growing		
Winemaking		
Wine: White Grape Variety Names	**Sicily**: Carricante **Sardinia:** Vermentino	Grillo, Inzolia, Catarratto
Wine: Red Grape Variety Names	**Sicily**: Nerello Mascalese, Nero d'Avola, Frappato **Sardinia:** Cannonau	
Classification	IGP, DOC, DOCG	
Wine Law / Appellations: DOCGs/DOCs	**Sicily:** Sicily DOC	**Sicily:** Etna DOC (Rosso and Bianco) Cerasuolo di Vittoria DOCG Marsala DOC **Sardinia:** Cannonau di Sardegna DOC Vermentino di Sardegna DOC
Label Terms		**Marsala:** Secco, Semi-Secco, Dolce
General Terms		
Style		Dry White Wines, Dry Red Wines, Fortified Wine (Marsala)
Producer/Proprietary Brand		Know producers if you recommend them at service in the Hospitality and Service Exam.
Vintage		
History & Lore		
Service of Beverage		
Food and Beverage Pairing		
Business of the Sommelier		